

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case No. 2020-6870

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF BRENNA STURGEON, LICENSE NO. LPC 6223,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners (“Board”) and Brenna Sturgeon (“Respondent”), as follows:

1. The Board has jurisdiction over the person of Respondent and the subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order (“Order”).
2. Respondent was licensed to practice as a professional counselor (“LPC”) in the State of Colorado on September 8, 2011, having been issued license number LPC 6223, and is currently so licensed.
3. This Order is a full and final resolution of case number 2020-6870. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.
4. Respondent admits the following:
 - a. On or around August 20, 2020, Respondent pled guilty to Stalking-threat/repeated Communication, a Class 5 felony, and Harassment-repeat Telephone Calls, a misdemeanor, in Case No. 2020CR3185 in District Court, EL Paso County, Colorado. She received a two (2) year deferred sentence on the felony conviction and was sentenced to two (2) years of supervised probation for the misdemeanor conviction, the sentences to run concurrently.
 - b. On or about August 24, 2021, Respondent underwent a mental status examination with Peer Assistance Services, Inc. (“PAS”). The evaluator concluded that Respondent is only safe to practice as a LPC with reasonable skill and safety, with treatment and monitoring.

5. By virtue of the admissions in paragraph 4 above, Respondent admits and the Board finds that Respondent violated section 12-245-224(1)(a) and (f)(II), C.R.S., which state:

12-245-224. Prohibited activities--related provisions. (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article 245 violates this article 245 if he or she:

(a) Has been convicted of or pled guilty or nolo contendere to a felony or received a deferred sentence to a felony charge. A certified copy of the judgment of a court of competent jurisdiction of the conviction or plea is conclusive evidence of the conviction or plea. In considering the disciplinary action, each board is governed by sections 12-20-202 (5) and 24-5-101;

(f)(II) Fails to act within the limitations created by a physical illness, physical condition, or behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that renders the person unable to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under his or her care.

6. By virtue of the admissions in paragraphs 4 and 5 above, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction(s) that the Board believes is necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

RELINQUISHMENT

7. Respondent hereby relinquishes her LPC license in the State of Colorado, commencing from the effective date of this Order, and requests that the Board accept said relinquishment. Such relinquishment shall have the same force and effect as a revocation ordered by the Board, including the provisions of section 12-20-404(3), C.R.S.

8. Following relinquishment of her license Respondent shall not perform any act requiring a license to practice.

9. Respondent understands that if she applies for licensure as a professional counselor at any future time, Respondent will be required to comply with all criteria for initial license that exist at the time of application.

10. Respondent also agrees not to register as a psychotherapist in the State of Colorado nor will Respondent perform any act constituting psychotherapy as defined under section 12-245-202(14), C.R.S.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

11. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

12. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

13. This Order shall become an order of the Board when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

14. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to sections 12-20-403, 12-245-214, 12-245-226, and 24-4-104(9), C.R.S.

15. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

16. Respondent shall obey all state and federal laws while this Order is in effect.

17. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Board. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

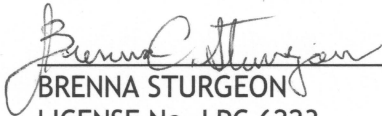
18. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Board, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Board. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Board.

19. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Board.

20. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

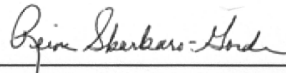
AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT


BRENNA STURGEON
LICENSE No. LPC 6223

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS


REINA SBARBARO-GORDON
Program Director

Effective this 6 day of December,
2021.